Treasure Island

When does a swarm of LLM agents whistleblow, and what in their environment changes that?

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Abstract

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Research conducted for the Multi-Agent Oversight and Control Research Sprint hackathon run by Apart Research, November 2026.
Code, every committed game and its model replies are at
https://github.com/al-beton/apart-swarm-alignment.



Figure 1: A placeholder teaser: one committed game, replayed from its log. The real one is a still from an exploit game.

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1 Introduction

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2 Related Work

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3 Methods

3.1 The game

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3.2 The agents

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3.3 Measuring whistleblowing

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4 Results

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4.1 Where the treasure lands decides the silent crew's score

In 1 of the 2 sample games (50%) the crew dug up the treasure, and it scored 115 on average.

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Figure 2: A silent crew searching the grid alone, replayed from the committed run `runs/silent-seed-7`. Rebuild it with `make figure NAME=silent-game`; play the game again with `uv run treasure-island run configs/silent.toml --seed 7`.

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5 Discussion and Limitations

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5.1 Future Work

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6 Conclusion

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References

Joon Sung Park, Joseph O'Brien, Carrie J. Cai, Meredith Ringel Morris, Percy Liang, and Michael S. Bernstein. Generative agents: Interactive simulacra of human behavior. In *Proceedings of the 36th Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology*, 2023.

Ethan Perez et al. Discovering language model behaviors with model-written evaluations. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2212.09251*, 2022.

A LLM Usage Statement

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. The authors chose the questions, designed the game and the experiments and directed the work; a team of Claude agents built the sandbox, its tests and the figures through a pull-request workflow, and OpenAI Codex reviewed each change. The authors take responsibility for every claim in the paper.

B Code and Data

Code, configs, run logs and archived model replies, MIT licensed: https://github.com/al-beton/apart-swarm-alignment. Every committed game replays offline with no API keys, and every figure rebuilds from those games.

C Limitations and Dual-Use / Ethical Considerations

C.1 Limitations

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C.2 Dual-use risks

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C.3 Ethical considerations

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D Reproducibility

Every game the paper reports is committed under `results/` and replays with `uv run treasure-island replay <folder>`, with no keys and no network. Every figure is named in `src/treasure_island/figures.py` and rebuilds with `make figure NAME=<name>`.